

OS X MAVERICKS

Apple unveiled OS X Mavericks last year with various improvements to Snow Leopard. In addition to the couple of features announced and showcased by Apple, many lesser known and secret features are hiding under the hood of this operating system. Here are some of our favourite tips and tricks related to the 10th major release of OS X.

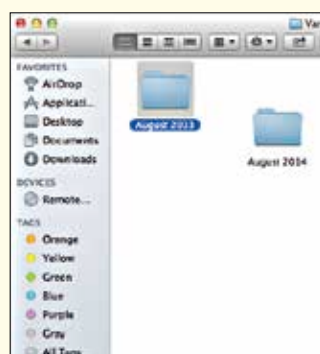
Block individual iMessage contacts

If you use Apple's iMessage service on your Mac, you probably know that there's no way to block individual contacts. You can only block contacts from sending you iMessages on your iOS device, but even despite blocking the messages you could still receive them on your Mac. Mavericks has come up with a neat feature that fixes the issue and lets you block individual contacts.

You can block contacts by opening the Messages app > Messages (in the menu bar) > Preferences > 'Accounts' tab > 'Blocked' tab > Click on the '+' icon > Select the contact you want to block.

Duplicate a folder and add ascending year

Another new option that the OS is offering is the ability to



Drag and drop the folder while holding the Option key



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{ Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference. }

duplicate folder names with ascending year. While this isn't exactly a hidden feature, it's only known by very few Mac users. Suppose you want to duplicate a folder named 'August 2013', just hold down the (Option) key while dragging the folder and a new folder named 'August 2014' will be created.

Use Finder tabs instead of new Finder windows

Finder is completely revamped with a new tabbed UI in Mavericks. Earlier, a new Finder would open in a separate window creating a clutter on the desktop. To reduce this mess, press [⌘] + [T], which will open a new Finder tab inside the same Finder window.

Merge all Finder windows

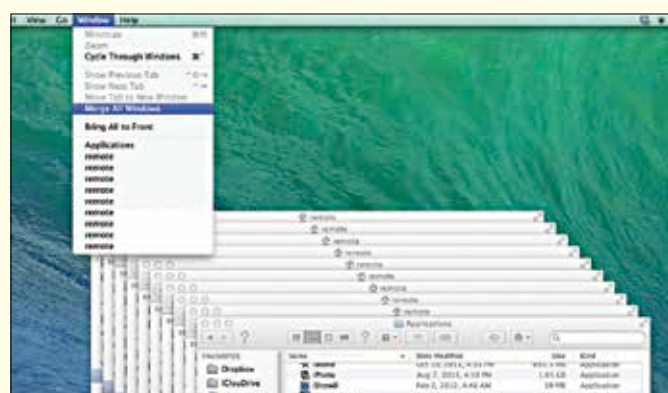
The tabbed view interface, which resembles Safari's interface, also lets you merge already opened windows.

To do this, click on any Finder window > Window

(in the menu bar) > Merge All Windows.

Screenshot specific window only

This is a very useful screenshot-taking tip that isn't a



Click on any Finder window and choose 'Merge All Windows from Window' in menu bar

part of Mavericks, but should be known by every Mac user. Taking screenshots in OS X is as easy as dragging and selecting the portion of your screen to be saved. However, there's an even easier way to do it using a keyboard shortcut. If you want to screenshot a particular window,

you don't have to drag and select the exact window portion. Instead, press [⌘] + [⇧] (Shift) + [4] + [Space bar] and select the window that you want to save.

Quickly disable notifications for the rest of the day

Mavericks introduced the 'Do not disturb' feature of iOS in Macs. The newly added feature lets you disable notifications for the rest of the day. While you can find it under 'Notifications' in 'Preferences', there's a quick way to manually enable or disable 'Do not disturb'.

To do it, press the (Option) key and click on the small notification centre icon located on the top-right corner of the menu bar.

Put your Mac to sleep with the power button

In the earlier versions of OS X, whenever you pressed the power button a dialogue box with options to restart, sleep or shut down would appear. However, Apple entirely changed the

behaviour of the power button in Mavericks. Now, pressing the power button for one second will turn off the display and lock your Mac. Pressing the power button for 2-3 seconds will bring up the same old dialogue box. Pressing the button for 10 seconds will turn off your Mac entirely.